

Quarterly Report for Deer Velvet in Korea – Deer Industry New Zealand

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Lewis Patterson / Jack Stenhouse

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Innovative Business Support & Promotion

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2 Imports

2.1 Velvet Imports

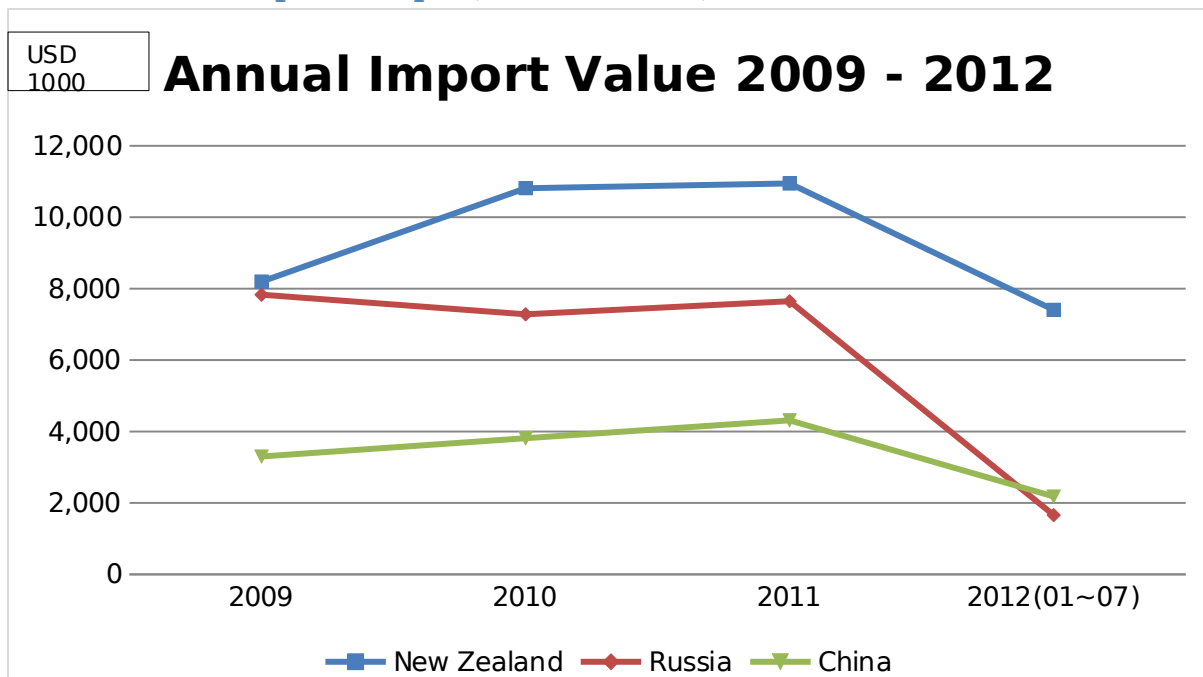
2.1.1 Young Antlers, Whole HS No. 0507.90.1110

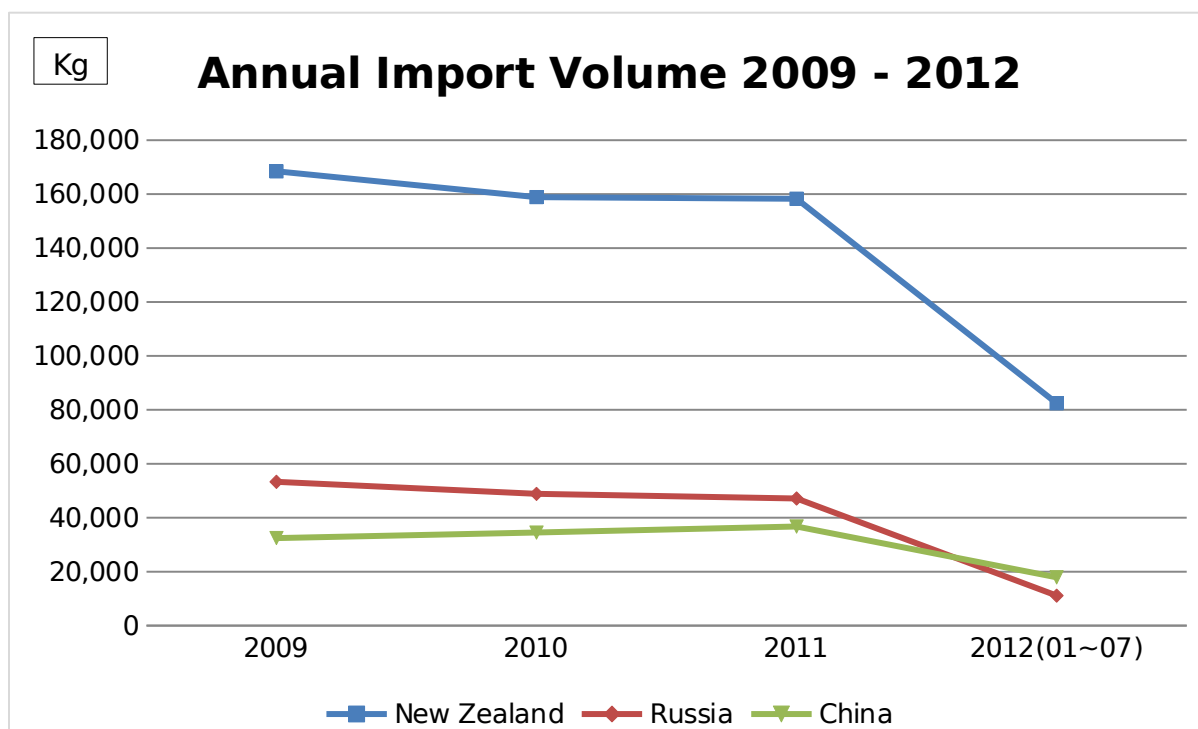
Rank	Country	2009			2010			2011			2012(1~07)		
		Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg
Total Sum		19,545	262,476		22,247	246,623		23,497	246,188		11,293	111,909	
1	N.Zealand	8,197	168,438	48.66	10,813	158,875	68.06	10,946	158,276	69.16	7,405	82,448	89.81
2	Pr.China	3,298	32,471	101.57	3,811	34,514	110.42	4,314	36,742	117.41	2,177	17,900	121.62
3	Russia	7,830	53,318	146.85	7,281	48,841	149.08	7,647	47,142	162.21	1,657	11,111	149.13
4	Australia	196	8,049	24.35	70	2,000	35.00	-	-	-	54	450	120.00
5	Kazakhstan	24	200	120.00	272	2,393	113.66	591	4,028	146.72	-	-	-
NZ Share (%)		41.94	64.17		48.60	64.42		46.58	64.29		65.57	73.67	

2.1.2 Young Antlers, Other HS No. 0507.90.1190

Rank	Country	2009			2010			2011			2012(1~07)		
		Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg
Total Sum		291	1,835		100	33		88	80		49	50	
1	N.Zealand	251	1,815	138.29	58	8	7,250.00	47	36	1,305.56	32	33	969.70
2	Australia	40	19	2,105.26	42	25	1,680.00	40	42	952.38	17	17	1,000.00
3	U.S.A	1	-	-	0	-	-	0	1	-	0	-	-
4	Pr.China	0	1	0.00	-	-	-	0	1	0.00	-	-	-
5	Russia	0	-	-	0	-	-	0	-	-	0	-	-
NZ Share (%)		86.25	98.91		58.00	24.24		53.41	45.00		65.31	66.00	

2.1.3 Annual Import Graph (whole antlers)





2.2 Hard Antler Imports (HS No. 0507.90.1200)

Rank	Country	2009			2010			2011			2012(1~07)		
		Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg	Value	Weight	\$/kg
	Total Sum	2,475	225,946		2,219	202,444		2,511	224,058		1,187	100,463	
1	Russia	2,088	190,538	10.96	2,000	183,000	10.93	2,508	224,035	11.19	1,186	100,448	11.81
2	Australia	0	1	0.00	63	6,024	10.46	2	20	100.00	1	14	71.43
3	Mongolia	-	-	-	62	5,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	Argentina	109	9,961	10.94	60	5,000	12.00	-	-	-	-	-	-
5	N.Zealand	123	11,314	10.87	34	3,420	9.94	0	3	0.00	0	1	0.00
6	Pr.China	156	14,132	11.04	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
	NZ Share (%)	4.97	5.01		1.53	1.69		0	0.00		0	0.00	

2.3 Quarantine Statistics of Deer Velvet from Major Exporters

2.3.1 Year to date

These include hand-carried velvet by tourists. The countries are not country of origin but export.

COUNTRY	JUL 10 - JUN 11		JUL 11 - JUN 12	
	DRIED VELVET (KG)	RAW VELVET (KG)	DRIED VELVET (KG)	RAW VELVET (KG)
New Zealand	26,141.3	116,769.7	28,202.0	82,763.0

China	60,639.2	27.2	61,595.3	6.5
Russia	34,510.8	0.4	36,045.0	-
Hong Kong	10,815.7	-	11,715.1	-
Kazakhstan	3,220.2	-	2,337.8	-
Australia	102.7	-	99.9	-
USA.	34.8	7.0	36.6	-
Singapore	1,025.4	-	-	-
Others	22.4	2.4	13.0	7.1
Total	136,512.5	116,806.7	140,044.7	82,776.6
Overall Total	253,319.20		222,821.30	

Source: National Veterinary Research & Quarantine Service 한국수의과학검역원

2.3.2 Full Year

These include hand-carried velvet by tourists. The countries are not country of origin but export.

COUNTRY	JAN 10 - DEC 10		JAN 11 - DEC 11	
	DRIED VELVET (KG)	RAW VELVET (KG)	DRIED VELVET (KG)	RAW VELVET (KG)
New Zealand	24,693.5	107,970.9	27,476.4	99,841.5
China	60,181.7	28.1	64,045.7	14.1
Russia	34,346.6	0.4	35,181.6	-
Hong Kong	22,379.1		9,560.1	-
Kazakhstan	2,683.7		4,029.3	-
Australia	97.8	2,005.5	101.2	-
USA.	55.5	4.4	32.9	5.5
Singapore	0.1		1,025.4	-
Others	43.2	5.6	9.7	6.3
Total	144,481.2	110,014.9	141,462.3	99,867.4
Overall Total	254,496.1		241,329.7	

Source: National Veterinary Research & Quarantine Service 한국수의과학검역원

3 Local Deer Industry

3.1 Market Price of Live Deer as of July 1 2012

			Elk	Sika	Red
2 Yr Old (2010 Born)	Female		102	42	50
	Male		233	57	70
3~4Yr Old	Female		137	52	63
	Male		283~383	67~85	82~100
		Avg	333	76	91
5 Yr and Older	Female		150	60	73
	Male				
	(Velvet production volume)		(Less 10 kg) 283	(Less 1kg) 75	(Less 3kg) 87
			(Less 10~13kg) 317~407	(Less 1~1.3kg) 78~88	(Less 3~5kg) 93~110
		Avg	362	83	102
			(Less 13~17kg) 420~583	(Less 1.3~1.7) 92~103	(Less 5~7kg) 112~128
		Avg	502	98	120
			(Less 17~20kg) 633~867	(Less 1.7~2.0kg) 108~120	(Less 7~9kg) 137~167
		Avg	750	114	152
			(Over 20kg) Over 1,067	(Over 2.0kg) Over 133	(Over 9kg) Over 180

3.2 Korea Deer Breeders Association protests Channel A's broadcast, June 22

The head of the Deer Association visits the headquarters of Channel A in order to protest the contents of a recent broadcast that claimed Korean deer velvet of very poor quality. He commented that the broadcast was biased, subjective, and lacked scientific evidence. The broadcast contained contents claiming that the quality of deer velvet is in the following order: Russian, Chinese, New Zealand and Australian, Korean. (The producers of the show have since agreed to consult with the Korea Deer Breeders Association before airing future broadcasts that contain any reference to deer velvet.)

Source: The Deer Times, 10 May 2012

3.3 From next year general food products can display 'good for the body' on their packaging - but not deer velvet

From next year milk, walnuts and similar natural food products are able to declare themselves as functional health foods. Korean deer velvet, however, is not included in this list. Such phrases as 'Milk helps bone health' and 'walnuts are good for heart health' will be able to be displayed. Before this the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) only recognised a certain section of functional health foods allowed to display such messages product labels (for example those products containing hongsam, glucosamine, or omega 3 fatty acid). In 2013 there is a plan also allow natural food products that have had their effects scientifically proven to advertise these effects. However, under existing law fresh deer velvet is classified as deer antler, and the FDA states that in the case of raw ingredients, there is a restriction where drying is performed and less than 50% of the original raw ingredient remains.

Source: The Deer Times, 20 May 2012

3.4 Deer Dream releases a female deer velvet drink

Deer Dream, producers of female deer antlers, has released a new Korean deer velvet drink under a fresh idea. The company is promoting the new product as a health drink, rather than an ingredient or medicine, in an effort to improve the stagnated nature of the market. Local deer farmers, however, say that existing laws only recognise the male deer's antlers as suitable for deer velvet use, and that promoting the product as a health drink may confuse the consumer and lead to an overall drop in sales and the value of velvet.

Source: The Deer Times, 10 June 2012

3.5 Drop in the volume of deer velvet production

This year the amount of velvet produced per animal has fallen sharply, around 2-3 kg per animal lower than last year. Every year there has been a slight downward trend, but this year appears to be particularly serious. Opinions on the cause are divergent. Among the possible causes, deer farmers seem most positive that it is due to a change in temperature. This year there was little rain and many fine days. Others blame it on an unbalanced feed system, whereby deer are fed low cost by-product feed.

Source: The Deer Times, 25 June 2012

3.6 2012 Deer Velvet Science Symposium to be held October 10th

The Korea Rabbit and Deer Association will host the 2012 Deer Velvet Science Symposium together with Geun-Guk University and the Korea Deer Velvet

Research Center on October 10th. Until this year the symposium has been held at the end of June, and was scheduled for early September, but due to it being the mating season and artificial insemination season it was put back until October. The symposium targets members of the Korean Deer Breeders Association and deer farmers, and more detailed information on this year's event will be revealed at the end of September.

Source: The Deer Times, 10 July 2012

4 SET / ICT

The reason for the push for removal of SET by the KDBA came, according to Carrol Song, from an importer being investigated (not specifically related to SET) and through this investigation the tax department becoming aware of the high distribution of frozen product (i.e. sold via local farms).

If the product is frozen it is therefore considered 'processed' and therefore should have SET applied. There would also then be an additional VAT component that would have to be calculated.

So while the government is technically applying an SET tax on even local velvet that is processed to date no local government official has actually chased it. According to Carol Song the word is this would in fact be charged retrospectively. Of course it only takes one agent to apply the law and all other local bodies would have to follow suit.

This is seen as a huge threat by the local farmers of course – hence strong desire to see removal of SET. The KDBA approached a senator last year in October, a Mr Jeong BeomGu and it made it on the legislation appeals list. However during the FTA (US) protests this senator was suspended and he was not elected as part of the new Assembly on the 31st May.

The KDBA has since approached another senator who will head the Agricultural division [Mr. Hong MoonPyo].

Carol is confident this will result in the request for SET on velvet being removed.

5 Other comments / meeting notes

5.1 NZ Embassy and NZTE

Met in Embassy building with Graeme, YG Shin and Jo McLeod. Discussion around QIA and WTO discussions.

- Noted DNA testing only helped identify species.
- Isotopic testing an option for identifying County of Origin but concern that if not handled well may end up just imposing an additional cost for NZ.

- Rhys noted that could still be viable if used as a auditing tool.
- Other options discussed such as comparing weights from e-certs (i.e. frozen in - dried output) but this is complicated by fact that bottom tynes can be removed etc...

[Rhys to supplement notes]

5.2 AKOM

The advertisement paid for by DINZ has been rolled out as scheduled with a 'bonus' appearing in the middle of the paper on the 6th of August.

The last run of the advertisement is due to be printed on the 24th of September.



5.2.1 Notes from meeting 2012-09-04

Met with Dr. Kim and Team Leader Noh for meal in SamCheongDong - Korean restaurant - [삼청동 북정식당].

Discussion summary:

- Yes there are trends in OM. Examples include weight loss, skin health, beauty, joint health etc...
- While the main focus was prevention 30 years ago that is not the case now at all. Dr. Kim estimated only 10-20% was strictly prevention [보약].
- Yes it is 'dynamic' in that it follows key health issues such as key health issues.
- While quality of ingredients has improved over time Dr. Kim noted there has not been any major change in the make-up of those ingredients.
- An emphasis on the benefits of breast-feeding is clearly part of a broader societal trend and is also reflected to some degree in OM also. There is also OM that is used by mothers that may need to stop breastfeeding earlier than 'normal'.

- Other OM doctors qualified in their own country or even experts in their own OM version (e.g. China, Taiwan...) are not able to practice in Korea. Nor can someone run a business practicing another countries style of OM. They have to go through the entire qualification process in Korea.
- Generally deer velvet market (relating to OM) is feeling the impact of global financial pressures.
- Noted that NZ research should link to with the likes of KyungHee University and other respected OM Universities.
- Explained why Korean children are considered to be one year old when born. Basically the age is calculated from when they start growing inside the womb.
- Noted they Association has been VERY busy due to an issue they with the government. Neither Team Leader Noh nor Dr. Kim would elaborate on what the issue was.
- Expressed ongoing concern about the general challenges faced by OM in Korea and Team Leader Noh expressly requested that Rhys continue to support AKOM and their industry and get a decent haircut.

Dr. Kim and Mr. Noh	Rhys, Stephen, Catherine, Dr. Kim's son, Dr. Kim's wife, Dr. Kim, Mr. Noh. [Good looking guy is taking the picture...]
	

5.3 Carol Song

Range of topics covered – not many deer velvet related. No notes taken from meeting.

5.4 KNC Trading

2012-09-05: Met in their office with Rhys, Stephen, Catherine

- Interested in challenging ASH content as really is not a valid measure. Requested support in this effort in terms of relevant research.

- Confirmed confidence that SET will be removed
- Initially sceptical about impact of removing SET in that it is applied to Chinese product also so price gap will remain.
- Had not heard of reduced Seika deer numbers
- Noted consistent 1 MT of dried product equivalent supplied into China from Russia.
- Noted very good prices being achieved for Hadae based on use of some of this product for traditional distribution. Especially where smaller tynes could be presented similarly to Sika antler. Even some instances of it surpassing USD 250/kg (confirming what Rhys had heard).
- Still supplying into Bogo

[Rhys to complete detailed notes that Lewis could not take due to translation]

5.5 TaeAhn Trading - President Ahn

2012-09-05:

Met in his office with Rhys, Catherine and Stephen.

- Main focus of conversation was around Elk and Mr. Ahn's determination to stop smuggled product from Nth America.
- Noted that some (around 11 MT) had been bought from US at price of USD 32 / lb early in season.
- However he rounded up the traders and took evidence of the smuggled product (in images) to customs which to date has lead to rejection of two separate shipments.
- This has caused 'problems' for those holding stock in China and also angered some Canadian farmers who have recently been offered only USD 25 / lb due to concern among traders about ability to on-sell.
- Wanted to know what DINZ would do to ensure that no NZ product was sent up to China.
- Pushed fact that business should be done direct to Korea and that the price had to be reasonable.
- After Rhys pointed out that it would be hard to convince farmers to take a lower price and that business only worked if there was mutual benefit Mr. Ahn conceded.
- Noted that Michael Park and other Korean reps back in NZ likely to approach the Elk / Wapiti Association in NZ to try and negotiate a settlement.

- Also hinted that another possible course of action would be to communicate direct with the OMDs and get them committed to not buying any Elk product.
- Over lunch noted that contrary to rumour he was not officially president of the Deer Importers Association at all. Had even avoided the gatherings for many years but recently attended one when-in he immediately got sucked in to fronting the Elk issue. No official title however.

5.6 President Bang

2012-09-05:

Meet in his office within the Korean Oriental Medical Herb Importers Association.

- Tough times
- Again noted that increasingly tough for importers with more companies going direct which means a shrinking 'pool' for the intermediaries.

[Rhys to fill in notes]

5.7 Peter Yoon

Caught up briefly with Dr. Yoon at his clinic. Clearly disappointed could not have diner.

After leaving were called back to check some velvet that had been delivered to him which he was not convinced was in fact genuine NZ velvet.

Samples given to Lewis to send to NZ for testing once paper-work provided by Stephen.

More samples delivered to hotel for checking the next morning.



5.8 Life & Gin workshop and other background notes

5.8.1 2012-09-06

Rhys Griffiths, Dr Stephen Haines, Ms Catherine Bryne, Lewis and Jack met with Mr Jeong (정호덕 차장님), Mr Song (송원종 본부장님),

Mr Kim (김종수 실장님), Dr Kim Byeong-Soo (김병수 한약사), and Dr Kim Jin-Gyeong (박사, 과장님)

KGC Intro:

- Have already had success with ginseng and red ginseng products and would now like to focus on building the strength of their deer velvet product range.
- The largest barrier to overcome with the current consumer thinking is the mindset that deer velvet is not something that anyone can consume safely. This was originally the case with ginseng too, a marketing barrier that was overcome with the introduction of red ginseng products. If deer velvet is to be registered as a functional health food it must be safe for consumption by all.
- The current situation is preferred by oriental medicine doctors, who thus retain a higher degree of power over the distribution of deer velvet. We therefore need more proof to show that deer velvet is ok for all and change the thinking of the consumer.
- Oriental doctors also try to make claims that red ginseng should not be made available to all and they should be the ones to prescribe it, but the consumer awareness of the product is at such a level now that not many pay attention to

this. This was not the case in the past. The same can be achieved with deer velvet.

- The results of deer velvet research can be used to inform the retailers/sellers who in turn inform the consumers.
- They are planning to focus more on increasing the number of shop in shops at pharmacies. There are around 85 already, and they are aiming to have another 15 open by the end of the year.
- Among the key products of the door to door sales business [ECHE], three contain deer velvet extract. These products are all in a high price range (one is around 600,000won).
- Another one of the challenges is making a product that is good for the body but tastes good at the same time. This is a must if the scale of the market is to increase.

DINZ/VARNZ intro:

- When marketing the product they will focus on making sure the product is direct to Korea.
- When compared with 5 years ago (500 tonnes) the amount of deer velvet supplied to China/Korea out of NZ was a similar level last season (480 tonnes). This level dropped for a few years but the industry is looking strong again. Prices are steady, expected small increase. Has seen 4 years of stable returns for producers.
- Existing efficacy studies have mostly focused on showing the safety of deer velvet, and as such there are limited results showing effect on immune system. This is the area in which KGC would like to focus in their effort to attain registration as a functional health food with the KFDA,
- In the past antlers were removed from 60 days, now at 55 days. Very small numbers at 30~40 days.

Discussion (carried on in different meeting room):

- Enquiry regarding possible funds for joint NZ/Korea research from the NZ govt. Rhys to look into this.
- Research results are most helpful to KGC if published in a peer-reviewed journal. These kinds of documents are most readily recognised by the KFDA.
- KGC plans to gain functional health food registration with the KFDA by 2014. This will be quite a fast progression if it does happen.

- They do not require raw data, but published results to show the KFDA.
- First the powdered velvet extract will be registered, and through this those products that contain determined levels of it will be able to be registered as functional health food products.
- They have had problems opening some of the links/references previously sent to them.
- There must be an active component in order to receive KFDA approval. First part of the process is getting this raw material and its form registered. The form needs to stay consistent throughout the registration process. Finally for approval of a finished product, it must be guaranteed that a fixed percentage of the active component, in the same form, is contained in this product.
- It may be because of the active component itself that they finished product can receive functional health food registration, or it may in fact only be a marker.
- Steven suggests a possible peptide that has been isolated for use as a marker (if in extract) - an assay could be set up. Isolated from previous Chinese study. Wound healing, nerve regeneration properties, but immune function uncertain.
- There is also the limitation of government certified laboratories to take into account. If the required experiment process is too complicated it may not be possible at all. The safety, invitro trials etc may be carried out in overseas labs, but the final stage (possible marker) must be carried out in registered Korean labs.
- There is no list of tests that are possible in these labs available from the KFDA.
- Rhys will look into possible small amounts of in-house funding. Need to go back with a firm proposal to get funding from the board.
- There are a range of potential active compounds but they depend of the nature of the extract. Some only suitable for alcohol-based. KGC's will be water-based. Chapter 6 of the manual explains this in more detail.
- KGC enquires if its possible to share with them the best method for creating an extract. VARNZ has developed an extraction method for water soluble extracts. Commercialised and sold to other countries previously. This technology may be applied, however it is a trade secret of VARNZ and licensed to others. May be possible to share this method with KGC, however, as the process will only be shown to the KFDA in order to achieve registration. No one but the KFDA will have access to this information.
- Life & Gin enquires about how DINZ reacts when receiving reports of a product leading to side-effects. Do they recommend lower doses for example? DINZ replied that there have only been a few of these reports in the last 10-15 years, and they are generally cases where the individual has been taking velvet in much higher than normal amounts (such as athletes). The highest dose used in

VARNZ in their trials was 2.7g perday for 10 weeks, and no adverse reaction was reported. Would need to be very high doses to see problems. A general product will go up to around 1.5g, so negative side-effects are unlikely. Possible to see problems with a rate of around 4g a day or more.

- Rhys comments that it would be great if NZ scientists could be used at some stages of the project (with funding from the NZ side)
- Dr Kim Jin-Gyeong is the point of point for KGC, and Catherine Byrne for VARNZ.

ACTIONS:

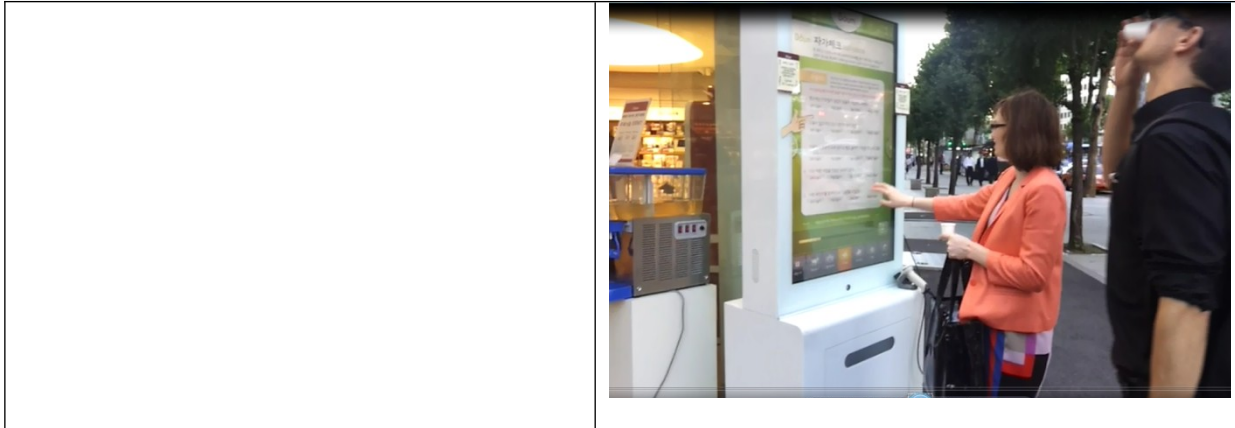
- Rhys to look into possible funds for joint NZ/Korea research from the NZ govt.
- Provide pdfs for all relevant research studies/results. Published articles best, but anything that relates to immune function, especially where human trials were involved, will be helpful (even if only report format)
- The most important data is that on safety; why/how NZ deer velvet is as good as or better than other countries' deer velvet;
- Life & Gin to send two signed copies of MOU to NZ. Sign both and return one back to Korea via mail.
- Rhys to send copy of general CDA to Life & Gin for review. Changes to this are expected.
- Quarterly skype/phone meeting and annual face-to-face discussed and agreed on.

At Boum store in head office



Boum store in Kangnam
[top - inside, bottom - outside interactive screen and tasting]





5.8.2 2012-07-31

Lewis and Jack met with Kim Byeong Soo at Latitude 45 office to discuss simplified version of MOU with DINZ.

- Will send two originals of final version to NZ. After signing one should be sent back to Korea.
- Interested in possibilities of research on areas such as suggested servings/dosage and components of velvet.
- Face-to-face workshop tentative date of Sept 5th. Two members of the research team will definitely attend.
- Also setting up meeting at the KT&Glife headquarters. One of the Gyeong-Hee University professors involved in the experiments will attend, and perhaps another from the research team.
- Mr Kim suggested that one full day with Rhys would be adequate.
- Mr Kim will be on holiday from August 6~10
- If Rhys okays the new version of the MOU they will draw up a final copy.
- Mr Kim mentioned that one of the people they are working with at Gyeong-Hee University also signs off on products presented with objective of obtaining functional health food status.
- With respect to the deer velvet ingredients of a product being used as a basis for functional health food status, Mr Kim was not certain. He noted that the components of deer velvet and their relation to good health are not yet definite, and that it is a difficult and long process to take out one component at a time and test in this fashion. KT&Glife does not have the technology for this yet. The strongest potential is for using 'improved immune system function' as a basis for the claim.

- Mr Kim also noted concern that Gwang-Dong has started research on similar product 6months~a year earlier than KT&Glife and as such may have their product out first. This product uses Korean deer velvet so there may be a problem with pricing.
- The latest market survey by the Korea Deer Breeders Association indicates that around 50% of Korean still believe Korean deer velvet to be the best in the world. For this reason KT&Glife need strong data from NZ that supports the superiority of NZ product. Also that 90% or more of the market is still with oriental doctors. There is potential for food products to grow.
- Mr Kim commented that in order to put the DINZ mark on a product, there would need to be meaning behind it. It would need a background campaign, and data for the marketing team etc.
- Suggests a change of the DNZ tick to something that has a relation to deer velvet so that the consumer can easily identify, for example antlers.
- The most important point to emphasise is the safety of deer velvet, that the DINZ mark should stand for this. Safety and trust. People are still uncertain about the effects and sideeffects of deer velvet, so this needs to be a foundation of the marketing campaign.
- Suggests more detailed information about NZ deer velvet to go in future ads in the AKOM newspaper as the audience are mostly highly trained oriental doctors who read it thoroughly. Statistics, research results etc.

6 Marketing material

As confirmed with Rhys a generic DINZ banner has been produced for use during trade shows or other functions as it relevant. [Note: our model, Jack Stenhouse, is 179 cm in height and actual banner dimensions are 1600mm x 800 mm].

This banner will first be used at the shared Omniherb booth at ICOM.

